Phrasal verbs y collocations de trabajo

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Los phrasal verbs y las combinaciones fijas de palabras son lo que hace que tu inglés suene natural en vez de traducido. Acá están los que más se usan en equipos de QA y desarrollo.

Cómo funcionan

Un phrasal verb es un verbo + una partícula (up, out, down, back, on, off…) que juntos tienen un significado propio: *set up* no es "poner arriba", es "configurar".

Tipo	Regla	Ejemplo
Separable	El objeto puede ir en el medio o al final. Si el objeto es un pronombre (it, them), va **siempre en el medio**.	I set up the pipeline. / I set the pipeline up. / I set **it** up. (nunca "I set up it")
No separable	El objeto va siempre después de la partícula.	I ran into a problem. / I ran into **it**.
Sin objeto	No llevan objeto.	The build broke down. / The service went down.

Conjugación: se conjuga solo el verbo, la partícula no cambia: *set up, set up, set up* / *ran into* / *has figured out* / *is rolling back*.

Phrasal verbs de testing, código y CI/CD

Phrasal verb	Significado	Ejemplo
set up	configurar, armar	I set up a nightly regression job in GitHub Actions.
run into	toparse con (un problema)	We ran into a timeout issue on staging.
figure out	descubrir, resolver	It took me two hours to figure out why the test was failing.
track down	rastrear hasta encontrar	I tracked down the bug to a caching issue.
narrow down	acotar	I narrowed down the problem to one specific browser.
roll back	revertir un deploy	We rolled back the release after the error spike.
roll out	lanzar de forma gradual	We're rolling out the feature to 10% of users.
break down	dividir en partes / dejar de funcionar	Let's break down this story into smaller tasks. / The runner broke down.
go down	caerse (un servicio)	The staging server went down during the demo.
come up	surgir	A critical bug came up the day before the release.
pick up	tomar una tarea	I'll pick up the ticket for the login tests.
clean up	limpiar	Each test cleans up its own data.

Phrasal verb	Significado	Ejemplo
look into	investigar	I'll look into the failing tests after lunch.
check out	revisar / bajar una rama	Check out this branch and run the tests locally.
point out	señalar	She pointed out a missing edge case in my test plan.
carry out	llevar a cabo	We carried out a load test before the launch.
fall back (on)	recurrir a un plan B	If the API fails, the app falls back on cached data.
spin up	levantar (un entorno, un contenedor)	The pipeline spins up a fresh database for each run.
tear down	destruir (un entorno)	We tear down the environment after the tests.
plug in	conectar, integrar	We plugged the reports into Slack.
phase out	dejar de usar de a poco	We're phasing out Selenium.
sign off (on)	aprobar formalmente	QA has to sign off on the release.
hold off (on)	posponer	Let's hold off on the deploy until the fix is merged.
fix up	arreglar / mejorar	I need to fix up the test data before the demo.
speed up	acelerar	Parallel execution sped up the suite.

Phrasal verbs de reuniones y colaboración

Phrasal verb	Significado	Ejemplo
follow up (on)	hacer seguimiento	I'll follow up on the open bugs tomorrow.
catch up	ponerse al día	Let's catch up after the stand-up.
bring up	sacar un tema	I brought up the flaky tests in the retro.
go over	repasar	Let's go over the test plan before the meeting.
sort out	resolver, ordenar	We sorted out the environment issues.
reach out (to)	contactar	I reached out to the backend team for help.
put off	posponer	We put off the migration until next quarter.
call off	cancelar	The demo was called off because of the outage.
step in	intervenir, reemplazar	I stepped in when our lead was on vacation.
take over	hacerse cargo	I took over the mobile automation last year.
hand over	entregar, traspasar	I handed over my tasks before my vacation.
come across	encontrarse con / dar la impresión	I came across a great article on contract testing.
keep up (with)	mantenerse al ritmo	It's hard to keep up with all the new AI tools.
run by	consultar con alguien	Let me run this idea by the team first.
get back to	responder más tarde	I'll get back to you on that by Friday.
point out	señalar	He pointed out that the requirement was unclear.
wrap up	terminar, cerrar	Let's wrap up the meeting with the action items.

Phrasal verb	Significado	Ejemplo
back up	respaldar (con datos o apoyo)	I backed up my point with data from production.
move on	pasar al siguiente tema	OK, let's move on to the next ticket.
sum up	resumir	To sum up, the release is on track.

Collocations: qué verbo va con cada sustantivo

En español decimos "hacer" para casi todo. En inglés cada sustantivo tiene su verbo.

Verbo	Va con	Ejemplo
run	tests, a suite, a pipeline, a query, a script	I ran the regression suite last night.
write	tests, test cases, a bug report, code, documentation	I wrote a detailed bug report.
file / log / raise / open	a bug, a ticket, an issue	I filed a bug in Jira. / I raised the issue with the PM.
fix	a bug, an issue, a test	The dev fixed the bug in an hour.
make	a decision, a mistake, a change, progress, a suggestion	We made the decision to delay the release.
do	a review, research, testing, a demo, your job	I did a code review of the test PR.
take	time, a look, notes, ownership, a break	Can you take a look at this failure?
give	feedback, a presentation, an estimate, a demo	I gave a demo of the new framework.
meet	a deadline, requirements, expectations	We met the deadline.
miss	a deadline, a bug, a meeting	We missed a bug in the payment flow.
reach	a goal, an agreement, a conclusion	We reached an agreement on the scope.
set	a goal, a deadline, priorities, expectations	I set clear expectations with the team.
gain	experience, knowledge, visibility	I gained a lot of experience with APIs.
catch	a bug, an error, an exception	The tests caught the bug before production.
ship / release	a feature, a version, a fix	We shipped the feature on Friday.
increase / improve	coverage, quality, performance	I increased coverage to 80%.
reduce / cut	time, costs, flakiness	We cut the pipeline time in half.
attend / join	a meeting, a call	I joined the call five minutes late.
ask	a question	Can I ask a question about the requirements?
pay	attention	Pay attention to the error messages.

Error típico: "make a test", "make a question", "do a mistake", "realize a test". Lo correcto: **run / write a test**, **ask a question**, **make a mistake**, **carry out a test**.

Expresiones idiomáticas de trabajo

Expresión	Significado	Ejemplo
on track	en camino, según lo planeado	The release is on track for Friday.
behind schedule	atrasado	We're a bit behind schedule because of the blocker.
a quick win	una mejora rápida y fácil	Adding retries to the API client was a quick win.
low-hanging fruit	lo más fácil de resolver primero	Let's start with the low-hanging fruit.
the bottleneck	el cuello de botella	Manual regression was the bottleneck.
a moving target	algo que cambia todo el tiempo	The requirements were a moving target.
in the loop	informado	Keep me in the loop on the fix.
up to speed	al día	It took me a week to get up to speed with the codebase.
on the same page	alineados	Let's make sure we're on the same page.
hands-on experience	experiencia práctica	I have hands-on experience with Appium.
from scratch	desde cero	I built the framework from scratch.
out of the box	listo para usar	Playwright supports parallel execution out of the box.
a learning curve	lo que cuesta aprender algo	Cypress has a small learning curve.
to cut corners	hacer las cosas a medias	We can't cut corners on payment testing.
a red flag	señal de alarma	A test that never fails is a red flag.
to ring a bell	sonar conocido	That error message rings a bell.
to touch base	contactarse brevemente	Let's touch base on Monday.
ballpark figure	número aproximado	Can you give me a ballpark figure for the testing effort?
it's not rocket science	no es tan difícil	Writing a good bug report isn't rocket science.
to go the extra mile	hacer más de lo esperado	She always goes the extra mile with test documentation.

Ejercicios

Mandame las respuestas en el chat con el número y te corrijo.

A. Completá con el phrasal verb correcto (en el tiempo que corresponda)

Opciones: set up, roll back, figure out, look into, follow up, run into, narrow down, wrap up

1. Yesterday we _____ a strange timeout issue on staging.
2. The deploy broke the login, so we _____ to the previous version.
3. I _____ the problem to one specific API call.
4. Last month I _____ a nightly job that runs the full regression.
5. I'll _____ the failing tests and let you know what I find.
6. It took us three days to _____ why the test was flaky.
7. Let's _____ the meeting, we're out of time.
8. I'll _____ with the backend team tomorrow about the fix.

B. Elegí el verbo correcto (collocations)

9. Can I **make / ask** a question about the acceptance criteria?
10. I **ran / made** the smoke tests after the deploy.
11. We **reached / did** an agreement on the scope.
12. I **did / made** a mistake when I configured the environment.
13. Could you **take / give** a look at this failure?
14. The tests **caught / took** the bug before it reached production.

C. Pronombres con phrasal verbs separables

15. Reescribí usando "it": I set up the pipeline last week.
16. Reescribí usando "them": We cleaned up the test users.
17. ¿Cuál es incorrecta? (a) I'll look into it. (b) I'll look it into. (c) I'll figure it out.

D. Producí

18. Contá en 3 oraciones un problema que tuviste en el trabajo usando: run into, track down, fix.
19. Escribí un mensaje de Slack de 2 oraciones usando: heads-up, hold off on.
20. Respondé "What was your biggest achievement?" usando: from scratch, speed up, hands-on.